MAGNET18 · 11:30 HOLD · @NQ FUTURES

Hypothesis:

Tested rule: at 11:30 ET, if NQ still holds session VWAP or the 09:30 open by 2 points, buy the next bar, flatten 15:30, no stop. That gate has a frequency edge in sample and out of sample. The mechanism is still an open case.

Why it should exist: 09:30–11:30 is where VWAP and the cash open get faded. If those prints are still held at 11:30, leftover sell flow is on the wrong side of a scorecard it cannot abandon. Tracking error, not a view. Not a squeeze. Persistence into the last hour is the harvest. 15:30 is the flatten, not MOC.

What this note proves: the frozen union gate is not a one-window fluke. What it does not prove: that the winner is VWAP-reclaim rather than "green at 11:30." That split is not in the fill list. Treat the mechanism as a hypothesis and the gate as the result.

PROVED

Union gate holds IS 58.7% and OOS 57.6%. Ungated last-30 is dead.

PROVED

11:30 beats later stamps. Lunch flatten and VWAP-stop kill it.

OPEN CASE

VWAP-reclaim vs never-left vs open-only. Same gate on ES.

Who loses

AM VWAP sell

Sold session VWAP 09:30–11:30 and lost the reclaim. Still short the scorecard at 11:30. Fade WR vs the live gate: 39%.

Who is forced

VWAP-benchmarked flow

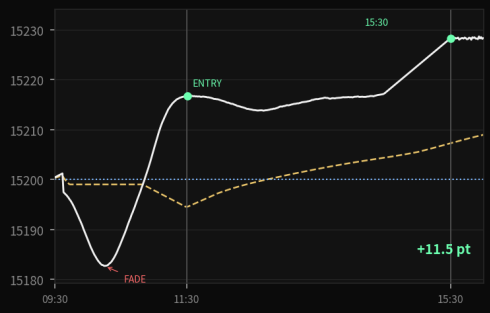
Tracking error, not a view. Does not need a squeeze. Needs to not finish short VWAP. Persistence, last hour.

Who wins

Long the VWAP reclaim

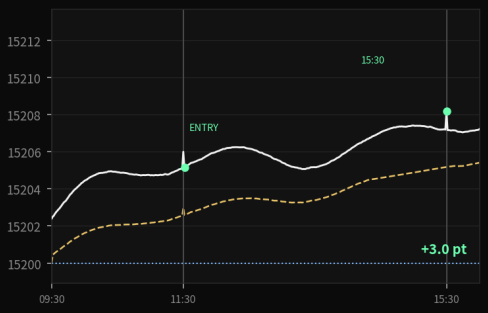
Already on the right side of the scorecard. Never-left is selection. T is leftover squeeze. Both must be weaker.

THREE TAPES · SAME 11:30 GATE · SCHEMATIC 1-MINUTE · NOT A SPECIFIC PRINT



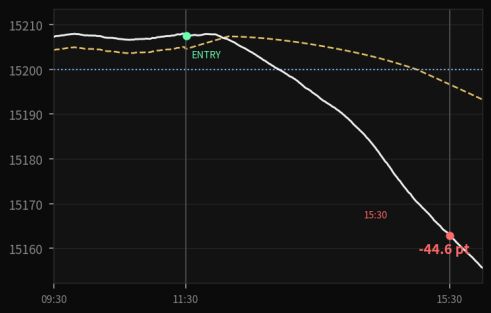
VWAP RECLAIM · THE CELL

AM sold VWAP, then lost. 11:30 long is tracking-error cover, not a breakout.



NEVER-LEFT · SELECTION

Never sold VWAP. Green at 11:30 is just an up day. Must lose to reclaim.



T-DAY · CHASE

Overnight already closed the short. Gate still green. No leftover VWAP sell.

IN-SAMPLE vs OUT-OF-SAMPLE · MULTICHARTS @NQ · SPLIT 2023-09-08 · INIT $50,000



Method:

Long-only NQ on 1-minute RTH bars. At 11:30 ET, if price is still holding session VWAP or the 09:30 open by 2 points, buy the next bar. Flatten 15:30. No stop. Frozen once. Not optimized on the vault.

INSTRUMENT	NQ futures. Authorship size 1 NQ. Flex ticket @MNQ.
BARS	1-minute RTH 09:30–16:15 ET. Next-bar only. IOG off.
LIVE CLOCK	Rithmic Central. 11:30 ET = 10:30 CT. Fill 10:31 CT. Flatten 14:30 CT.
IN-SAMPLE	Date < 2023-09-08. This export: 2016-09-06 to 2023-09-07, 1,590 trades.
OUT-OF-SAMPLE	Frozen split 2023-09-08. Multicharts OOS runs through 2026-08-17: 698 trades.
COST	Research 2.0 ticks RT = 0.50 pt. MC cheap-cost export is the replication. $5/contract slip is not.
PROPOSED TEST	Reclaim (AM traded VWAP or open, then held at 11:30) vs never-left vs T. Not in the live rule yet.
FROZEN GATE	+2 pt clearance, 11:30 stamp, 15:30 flatten. Named once. No vault parameter search.
SCOPE	NQ only. No ES. No GC. No glue onto overnight-T.
VERSIONS	MAGNET18 = 1 NQ, UseVolSize false. Flex = @MNQ nLots 4, UseVolSize true, nLotsLo 2.
SIZE OVERLAY	Moreira–Muir, size only. High 22-day RV → 2 MNQ. Quiet → 4 MNQ.
NAMED KILLS	Holiday skip failed 60% WR (2019 red). VWAP-stop dropped WR to 37.9%.
NOT THIS	Gao/Baltussen last-30. 5-minute ORB. Unconditional overnight fade. Leftover T. 02:00–03:00.

Why 11:30

Same gates, next-bar, flatten 15:30. Only 11:30 clears 60% WR, 7 pt mean, and 3 trades per week together. 11:00 is 58.5% / +6.7. 14:00 is 56.5% / +4.37. The live rule is the dense union so 3 per week holds.

Open pushes N. VWAP pushes mean.

VWAP+2 alone: 61.4% / 7.52 pt / 2.64 per week. Open+2 alone: 60.3% / 6.08 / 2.55. Need the union. AND both magnets kills density. Open+2 is the frequency pusher, not the whole edge.

Lunch is a tax. Sit it.

12:00–13:00 costs −1.30 pt. Flattening at 12:00 or 13:00 kills 60% WR. 15:00–15:30 is +1.59 of the +7.07. That hour is the harvest, not toxic MOC. A VWAP-stop clips it.

Not leftover T. Not London close.

Fat overnight (T) days: MAGNET −4.03 pt. After a fat up night: −13.55 pt, n = 74. 11:30 ET = 16:30 London most of the year. DST-mismatch weeks 53.3%. Killed. This is a US 11:30 hold.

Results:

WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	PROFIT FACTOR	NET PROFIT
58.3%	$164.56	1.30	$376,507

TRADES	MAX DD	IS WR	OOS WR
2,288	−$39,760	58.7%	57.6%

IN-SAMPLE vs OUT-OF-SAMPLE · MULTICHARTS EQUITY · VERTICAL LINE = 2023-09-08



Cell	Book	n	WR	Mean	Last hour
CLAIM · NOT RUN					
VWAP-reclaim	–	–	–	–	–
Never-left	–	–	–	–	–
RESEARCH IS · 1 NQ · 0.50 PT RT · 2017-06-06 → 2023-09-07					
VWAP+2 only (hold, not reclaim)	IS	2.64/wk	61.4%	+7.52 pt	–
Open-only +2	IS	2.55/wk	60.3%	+6.08 pt	–
Live union +2	IS	949	60.8%	+7.07 pt	+1.59 pt
Inside OR @ 11:30	IS	–	–	+10.13 pt	–
Above ORH @ 11:30	IS	–	–	+4.17 pt	–
T · fat up night	IS	74	–	-13.55 pt	–
Skip T	IS	2.47/wk	61.3%	+9.51 pt	–
Ungated 15:01–15:30	IS	–	51.6%	-0.43 pt	-0.43 pt
MULTICHARTS · USEVOLSIZE TRUE · $5 SLIP · 2016-09-06 → 2026-08-18					
IS < 2023-09-08	MC	1,590	58.7%	$118.40	–
OOS ≥ 2023-09-08	MC	698	57.6%	$269.71	–
All 2016–2026	MC	2,288	58.3%	$164.56	–

Missing rows need the AM tape under VWAP. Not recoverable from the fill list. Do not mix IS points with MC dollars.

Conclusion:

The frozen 11:30 union gate is the result. IS 1,590 trades, 58.7% WR, +$118. OOS 698 trades, 57.6% WR, +$270. Alternative clocks fail. That is the proof. VWAP-reclaim vs never-left is not in this book.

Two versions. No vault optimization. +2 / 11:30 / 15:30 frozen. That reduces, but does not eliminate, regime risk. Mechanism remains open. Frequency edge, not a squeeze (avg win $1,228 vs avg loss −$1,325). Do not send this as proof of leftover inventory.

NAMED KILLS · SAME GATES, THESE DO NOT GET TO CHANGE THE RULE

Holiday skip

WR 59.1%. 2019 went red. The 34 overnight holds were 64.7% WR. Data says keep them.

VWAP-stop

WR 37.9%. It clips 15:00–15:30. The harvest is the point of the trade.

Skip T

61.3% / +9.51 pt / 2.47 per week. Cleaner book, fails the 3/week density.

Lunch flatten

12:00 or 13:00 kills 60% WR. 12:00–13:00 costs −1.30 pt. Sit it.

Blind late long

Unconditional last 90 minutes 54.8% / +1.80. Last 30 51.6% / −0.43. Clock without the gate is dead.

London close

11:30 ET = 16:30 London most of the year. DST-mismatch weeks 53.3%. This is a US 11:30 hold.

What I will not do: glue onto T, add a stop, skip holidays on the authorship file, or change the gate after watching the vault.

What I want feedback on:

1. I cannot split reclaim vs never-left from fills. If you have the AM tape, that table is the next proof. If never-left ≈ reclaim, I drop the inventory sentence.

2. Run the same 11:30 gate on ES. Same institutions, less Nasdaq drift. If ES is dead and NQ is alive, this is a beta story. If both live and last-hour concentrated, it is a benchmark story.

Attached:

Attached: markdown table

Cell	Book	n	WR	Mean	Last hr
VWAP-reclaim	—	—	—	—	—
Never-left	—	—	—	—	—
VWAP+2 hold	IS	2.64/wk	61.4%	+7.52pt	—
Open+2	IS	2.55/wk	60.3%	+6.08pt	—
Union +2	IS	949	60.8%	+7.07pt	+1.59pt
Inside OR	IS	—	—	+10.13pt	—
Above ORH	IS	—	—	+4.17pt	—
T fat-up	IS	74	—	−13.55pt	—
Skip T	IS	2.47/wk	61.3%	+9.51pt	—
Ungated last-30	IS	—	51.6%	−0.43pt	−0.43pt
MC IS	MC	1590	58.7%	$118.40	—
MC OOS	MC	698	57.6%	$269.71	—
MC all	MC	2288	58.3%	$164.56	—